5.1 Plate Tectonics

Video: Plate Tectonics (Edpuzzle Original)

What Is Plate Tectonics?

Millions of years ago, Earth looked very different. The continents have moved thousands of _____.

_____ is a theory that explains how large pieces of Earth's surface move over time.

Even under the deep ocean water, it's all _____. The land on Earth's surface, including land below water, is called _____.

Two Types of Crust

Type of crust	Thickness
_____ crust	thick
_____ crust	somewhat thinner

The crust is broken up into many large pieces of rock called _____.

The cracks and breaks in the crust that create the plates are called _____.

Why Do Plates Move?

Both types of crust lie above another layer, the _____.

Much of the mantle is a hot, thick layer of molten, or _____, rock that can flow.

The mantle is heated by Earth's _____ and moves in big, curved paths.

Three Types of Plate Boundaries

Boundary	How the plates move	Example from the video
	Two plates move toward each other (collide)	The _____ mountains
	Two plates slowly move apart	South America and _____ were connected long ago
	Plates slide past each other	The San Andreas Fault in _____

At convergent boundaries, colliding plates push the crust upward, forming many _____ and volcanoes.

At transform boundaries, plates grind against each other and release lots of energy, which we feel as _____.

Think About It

The coasts of South America and Africa fit together like a puzzle. In your own words, explain why: _____